Several international conferences also paved the way for highlighting women's issues. The important among them were Mexico Women's Conference (1975), Copenhagen Women's Conference (1980), Nairobi Women's Conference (1985), Vienna Human Rights' Conference (1993), Beijing Women's Conference (1995), and the like. The year 1975 was declared as the International Women's Year and 1976–1985 was declared as the UN Decade for Women. These were milestones in bringing women issues to the forefront. The adoption of UN Convention on the elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) (1979) and the UN General Assembly Declaration on the Elimination of Violence Against Women (1993) symbolized the victory of Women's political campaigns held globally. Three conferences also boosted the launch of feminist thought into the IR study. They were the *Millennium: Journal of International Studies* Conference at the London School of Economics (1988), the Conference at the University of Southern California (1989), and the Conference at Wellesley (1990).

In 1997, in a debate led by J. Ann Tickner in the International Studies Association's *International Studies Quarterly*, she suggested three types of misunderstandings that were to be blamed for the lack of insight of IR scholars regarding woman's issues. They are: (i) misunderstandings about the meanings of gender; (ii) different ontologies; and (iii) epistemological divides. Tickner in her *Hans Morgenthau's Principles of Political Realism: A Feminist Reformulation* (1988*)* presented a reformulation of Morgenthau's six principles of Political Realism, which is the dominant perspective in International Relations and very much masculine in nature, focusing only on power politics.

Therefore, Tickner criticizes realism as only "a partial description of international politics," owing to its deeply embedded masculinist bias. Her main concern is to offer a "*feminist reformulation"* of certain realist principles. They were:

- Objectivity is culturally defined – and is associated with masculinity – so objectivity is always partial.
- National interest is multi-dimensional – so not one set of